



OPPOSITION ANALYSIS

FEYENOORD

Feyenoord are a controlled, left-loading possession side. They overwhelm you with volume and finish ruthlessly, but they rarely counter, and the clearest chances they give up come when their own build-up is pressed and turned over.

SCOUTING WINDOW

Eredivisie 2022/23 · matchdays 1 to 10 · 10 matches (7 Aug to 16 Oct 2022)

Source: Opta F24 event data and F7 line-ups. Every metric computed from the raw feeds.

PREPARED BY

Mats van Eijk

GAME PREPARATION ANALYST · WORK SAMPLE



The 60-second briefing

TEAM PROFILE

Record (this window)	7 W, 2 D, 1 L. 26 scored, 11 conceded.
Style	Possession-led (58%), in a mid-block out of possession.
Shape	Five games 4-2-3-1, five 4-3-3; the 4-3-3 is sharper.
Attack	18.7 shots and 1.83 xG a game, and they out-finish it.
Build-up	They play through you (10% long balls) and load the left.
Where they crack	Almost a third of shots conceded follow a turnover.

FIVE THINGS THAT DECIDE THE GAME

1. Make it a transition game, because they will not

They keep 58% of the ball, yet they managed a single fast-break shot in ten games. This is a control side, not a counter side. A patient passing contest is exactly what they want, so the more we turn the match into repeated transitions, the more uncomfortable they become.

2. Press their build-up, that is where they crack

Almost a third of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) arrive within fifteen seconds of a Feyenoord turnover, and those turnovers happen in their own half. Win the ball high and a clear chance usually follows, so we commit to pressing the first phase rather than sitting off.

3. Their threat runs down the left

Forty-one per cent of their final-third entries and 58% of their crosses come from the left, where Hancko and the left-back build and Idrissi isolates one-against-one. We overload our defensive right and we never leave our right-back on his own.

4. Strike early, because they own the late game

The only fifteen-minute window where they are out-chanced is 15 to 30 minutes (2.9 xGA, four conceded). After the hour they are ruthless: twelve goals scored, one conceded. Landing the first blow matters more against this side than against most.

5. The box is a battleground at both ends

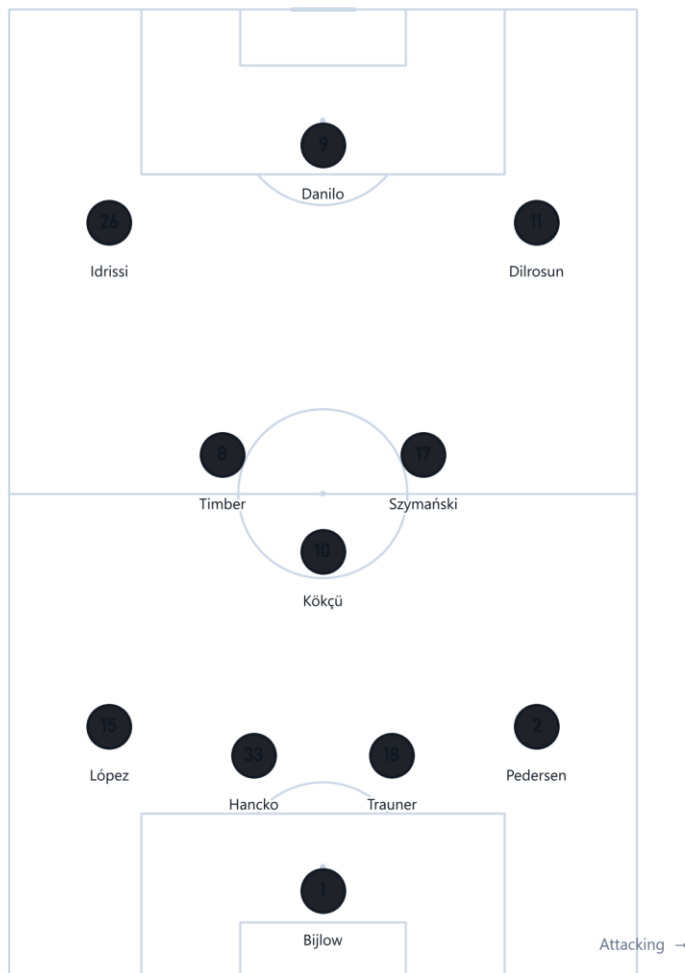
They scored five set-piece goals and conceded three. Their corners come mainly from the left and are aimed at the near post, and their open-play crossing finds a team-mate only a quarter of the time, so defending our box and threatening theirs both pay off.

02



Their most-used eleven

MOST-USED ELEVEN · LIKELY 4-3-3



THE SHAPE

They split the window evenly between a 4-2-3-1 and a 4-3-3, but the 4-3-3 shown here is their sharper, more left-loaded version and the one to prepare for first.

Bijlow builds with Trauner and Hancko, Kökçü drops in as the single pivot, and Timber and Szymański play ahead of him with licence to drift and arrive in the box.

The width and the danger come from the left. Pedersen on the right is more of an overlapping outlet, and Danilo leads the line on the last shoulder.

ROTATION & BENCH

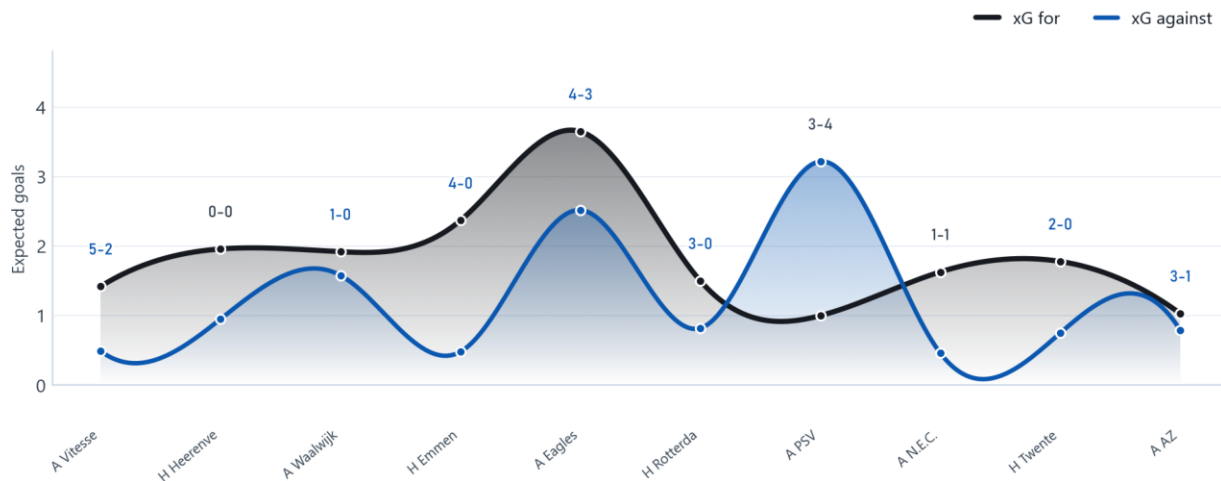
The spine is settled, so the eleven above is a confident base rather than a guess: Bijlow, Trauner, Timber and Dilrosun started all ten matches, with Kökçü, Hancko, Pedersen and Danilo close behind.

- Geertruida and Rasmussen are the main defensive alternatives and can both step into midfield.
- López and Hartman cover at left-back, the source of most of their attacking width.
- Giménez is the like-for-like striker off the bench and is pushing Danilo hard for the shirt.

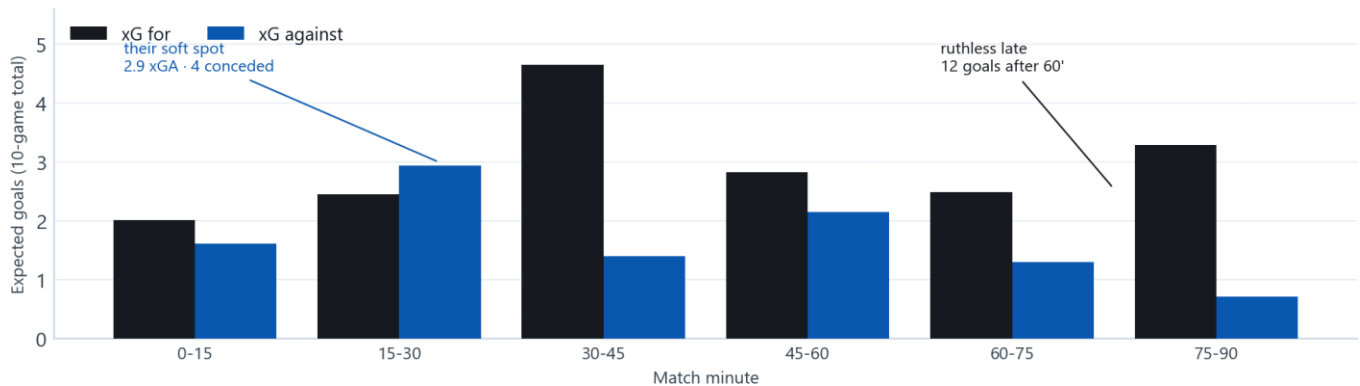


Who they are, and how it's gone

EXPECTED GOALS, MATCH BY MATCH



WHEN THEY HURT YOU, AND WHEN YOU HURT THEM



Dominant, and rarely troubled

Seven wins from ten and 26 goals tell the story, and the underlying numbers back it up: their xG sits above their xG-against in eight of the ten games. They control matches and out-create opponents, so a patient passing contest plays straight into their hands.

The exceptions are the lesson

The two blue spikes are where it went wrong for them. The 3-4 defeat at PSV (3.2 xGA) and the 4-3 win at Go Ahead Eagles (2.5 xGA) were both open, end-to-end games full of transitions. That is the kind of match we want to recreate.

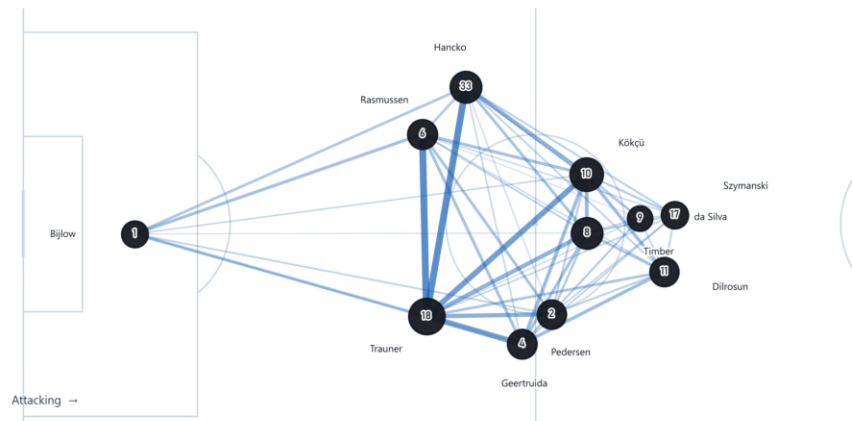
Strike early, fear the late game

The only fifteen-minute window where they are out-chanced is 15 to 30 minutes (2.9 xGA, four conceded). After the hour they took over completely, scoring twelve and conceding one. The first goal matters more here than it does against most sides.

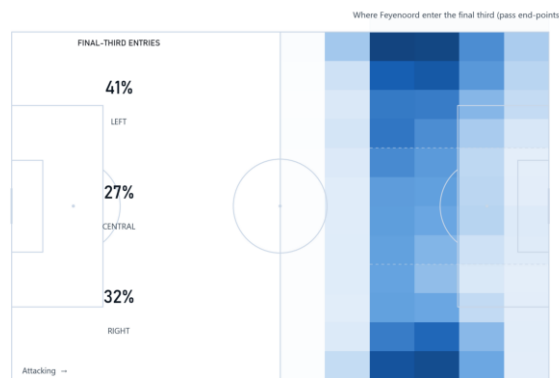
04



BUILD-UP SHAPE · NODE = INVOLVEMENT, LINE = PASS VOLUME



WHERE THEY ENTER THE FINAL THIRD



58%

OF ALL PASSES

10%

LONG BALLS

22.1

PROGRESSIVE/GAME

18.9

CROSSES/GAME

25%

CROSSES DONE

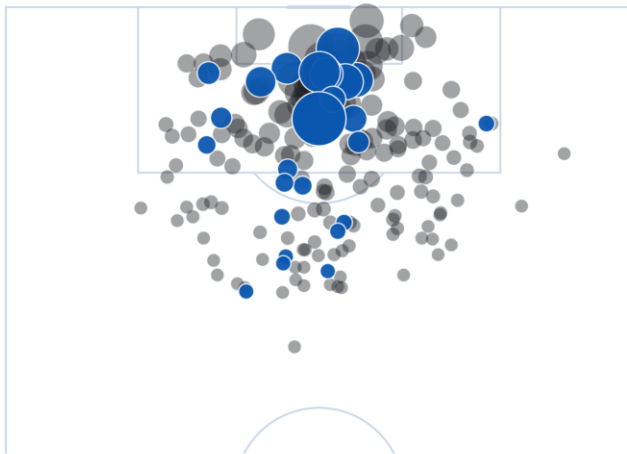
WHAT IT MEANS

- They play through you, not over the top. Only one pass in ten is long, and Kökcü (888 touches, 39 progressive passes) drops in to set the tempo around halfway. Screen the lane back into his feet and the build-up tends to stall.
- The bias is clearly to the left: 41% of their final-third entries and 58% of their crosses come down that side, with Hancko and the left-back building, Idrissi isolating and Szymański drifting across.
- The crossing is high in volume but modest in quality, 18.9 a game at 25% completion. A well-populated box and a focus on the second ball takes most of the sting out of it.
- On the right, Pedersen pushes high as an overlap-and-cross outlet rather than a creator, so our left side has to be alert to the runner underneath him.



Where the goals come from

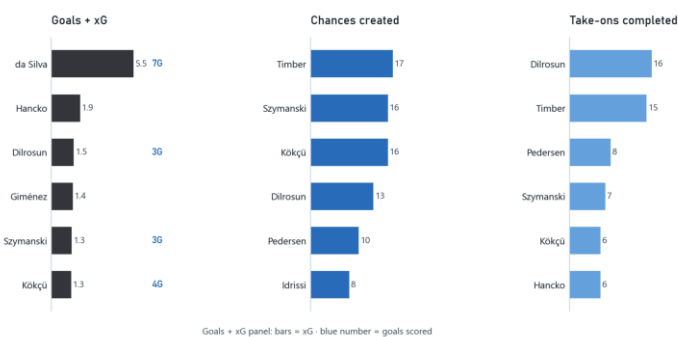
EVERY SHOT · SIZE = xG · BLUE = GOALS



ATTACKING OUTPUT

187	SHOTS
26	GOALS
18.3	XG
+7.7	OVER-PERFORMANCE VS XG
58.3%	SHOTS IN THE BOX
28	BIG CHANCES CREATED

TOP CONTRIBUTORS ACROSS THE WINDOW



They manufacture central chances, and they finish them

This is not a hopeful side. They created 28 big chances in ten games and take 58% of their shots from inside the box, working the ball into the highest-value areas before they pull the trigger. They are also finishing well above expectation, 26 goals from 18.3 xG, so the message for our back line is simple: give them nothing clean, and do not bank on them missing.

The goals are spread behind one main finisher

Danilo leads the line and the scoring with seven goals from 5.45 xG, but the threat does not stop with him. Kökçü chips in from midfield and the spot, Dilrosun and Szymański weigh in from wide and between the lines, and Timber arrives late from deep. Giménez is the like-for-like off the bench, so the plan cannot revolve around stopping one player.

Set pieces are a genuine route to goal

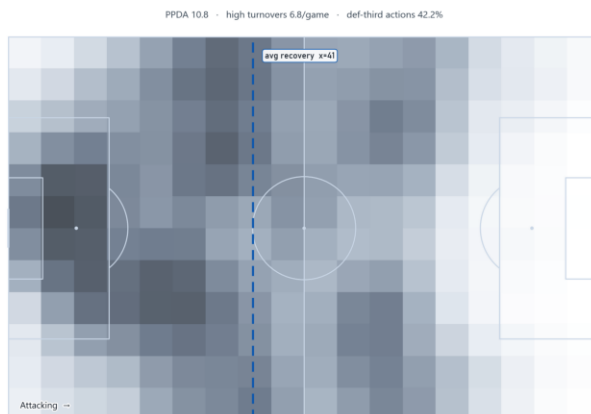
Around one in five of their shots comes from a set piece (39 shots, five goals, 5.8 xG). Their corners come mostly from the left and are aimed at the near post, with Trauner and Hanco attacking the ball and Kökçü delivering. We defend these with full numbers and concentration on the near post, and we treat our own set pieces as a real chance to hurt them.

06



Their block & their two shapes

DEFENSIVE ACTIONS · WHERE THEY WIN IT BACK



10.8

PPDA

x41

AVG RECOVERY

42.2%

ACTIONS DEF THIRD

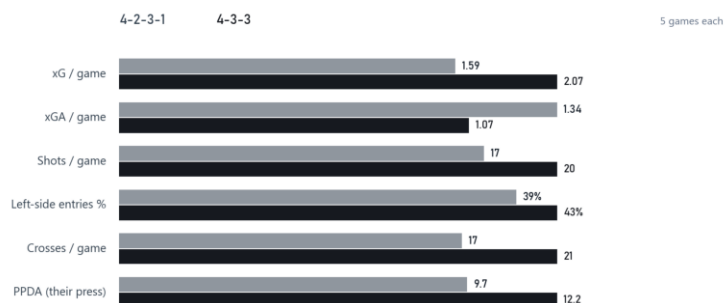
14.5%

ATT THIRD

6.8

HIGH TURNOVERS/G

A TALE OF TWO SHAPES · 5 GAMES EACH

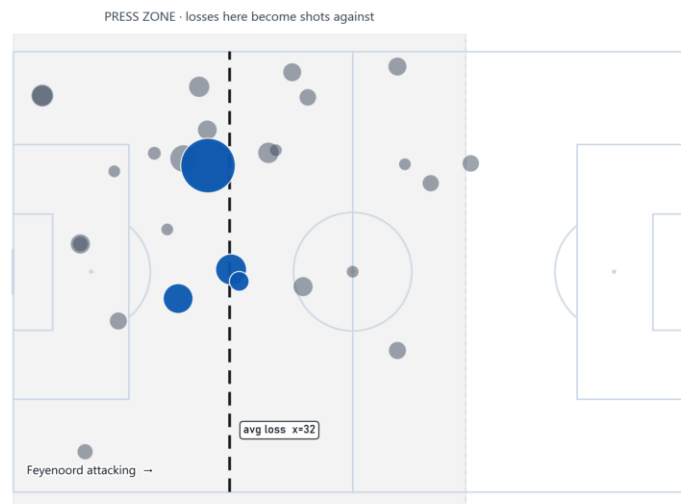


READ IT IN-GAME

- In the 4-3-3 they are sharper and more left-loaded (2.07 xG, 43% of entries left, 1.07 xGA) and they press less (PPDA 12.2). Against this shape we build patiently and double up on their left.
- In the 4-2-3-1 they are more balanced but leakier (1.34 xGA) and they press a touch higher (PPDA 9.7), which leaves more room behind. Here we bait the press and release runners early into that space.
- Either way they sit in a mid-block and recover around halfway rather than hunting high up the pitch, so we will get time on the ball in our own half. What we do with that time is the whole game.



BALL-LOSSES THAT BECAME A SHOT WITHIN 15S · BLUE = LED TO A GOAL



29%

SHOTS FROM TURNS

28

TRANSITION SHOTS

3.88

TRANSITION XGA

x32

AVG LOSS (THEIR HALF)

11

GOALS CONCEDED

THREE WAYS TO HURT THEM

Press their build-up, do not sit off

Close to a third of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) come within fifteen seconds of a turnover, and those turnovers happen in their own half (average x of 32). Trigger the press on the pass back to Trauner or Bijlow and screen Kőkü so he cannot turn. This is our single clearest route to a chance against them.

Make it transitional, and strike early

Their only sub-par window is 15 to 30 minutes (2.9 xGA), and after the hour they are ruthless: twelve goals scored, one conceded. Take an early lead and keep the game open, because they barely counter themselves (one fast-break shot in the whole window).

Win the box on set pieces

They conceded three set-piece goals in ten games and their crossing only lands a quarter of the time. We defend our box with full numbers, then go after theirs: load the far post and play for the second ball.

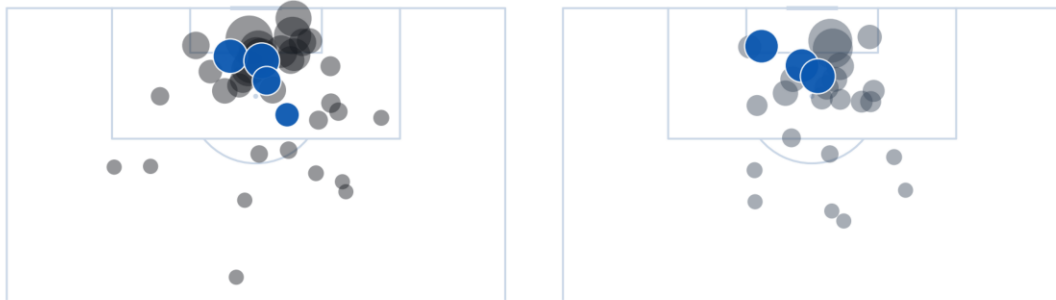
One honest note: roughly a quarter of the xG they conceded comes from a single game (PSV). The transition weakness is real, but it is partly concentrated, so treat it as a lever to confirm on video rather than a guarantee.



SET-PIECE SHOTS · THREAT (LEFT) VS CONCEDED (RIGHT)

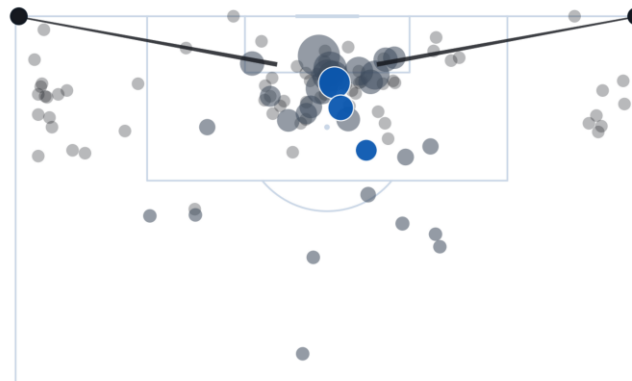
THREAT · 39 shots / 5 goals / 5.8 xG

CONCEDED · 26 shots / 3 goals / 3.1 xG



THEIR CORNER DELIVERY AND FIRST CONTACT

48 left corners / 27 right corners · mostly to the near post · 5% short corners



5

SP GOALS FOR

3

SP GOALS AGAINST

75

CORNERS

48/27

LEFT/RIGHT

5%

SHORT

DEFEND IT / ATTACK IT

- Defending theirs: their corners come mostly from the left and are aimed at the near post (42 of 70 box deliveries; only 5% are short). We attack the near post and the first contact, put bodies on Trauner and Hancko, and win the central second ball.
- Attacking theirs: they conceded three set-piece goals in ten games and their open-play crossing finds a team-mate only a quarter of the time, so we overload their box, target the far post and work the second phase.
- Recycling: their full-backs commit forward to attacking corners, which means a cleared set piece becomes our transition trigger. The first outlet has to break immediately into the space they leave behind.



Who to plan around

Orkun Kökçü

10 · Deep pivot

The heartbeat of the side: 888 touches, a team-high 39 progressive passes, 16 chances and four goals, plus the set pieces. He drops to receive around halfway, just left of centre. Get tight and stop him turning, and the build-up slows right down.

39

PROG PASSES

16

CHANCES

888

TOUCHES

Quinten Timber

8 · Box-to-box

Their best one-against-one player (27 take-ons at 56%) and top creator from deep with 17 chances, across 924 minutes. He covers ground and arrives in the box. Whoever marks him has to track his forward runs, not just his starting position.

17

CHANCES

56%

TAKE-ON WIN

27

TAKE-ONS

Dávid Hancko

33 · Left centre-back

The engine of the left-sided build-up and their second most progressive passer, with a set-piece threat too (1.9 xG). He steps into midfield to move the ball, and the space he leaves behind is exactly where we want to attack in transition.

31

PROG PASSES

1.9

SET-PIECE XG

614

MINUTES

Sebastian Szymański

17 · Attacking mid

Plays between the lines and drifts to the left. Three goals, 16 chances created, take-ons landing at 50%. A midfielder has to pick him up in the half-space before he turns, because once he is facing our goal he hurts you.

3

GOALS

16

CHANCES

50%

TAKE-ON WIN

Javairô Dilrosun

11 · Roaming forward

A high-volume dribbler who roams across the front, on average slightly to the right. He tries plenty (46 take-ons) but lands only 35%, with a team-high 49 box touches. Stay patient, show him inside and deny the entry rather than diving in.

46

TAKE-ONS

35%

WON

49

BOX TOUCHES

Danilo

9 · Striker

Their main finisher, seven goals from 5.45 xG, living on the last shoulder. Disciplined depth from our centre-backs is essential. Giménez is the like-for-like off the bench, so the threat barely changes when he comes on.

7

GOALS

5.45

XG

8

STARTS



The concrete recommendations

WITH THE BALL

- Win it and go. Nearly a third of the shots they concede begin with a turnover in their half.
- Front-load the game: target the 15 to 30 minute window and do not bank on chasing them late.
- Attack the channel Hancko vacates when he steps in, with a runner breaking from our right.
- Use our set pieces. They concede from them, so rehearse far-post and second-phase routines.

WITHOUT THE BALL

- Press their first phase. Trigger on the pass back to Trauner or Bijlow and screen the lane into Kökçü.
- Force them to cross from deep on the left, then win the box, both first contact and second ball.
- No isolated duels for our right-back against their left; the winger tracks the overlapping back.
- Hold a connected mid-block. They barely counter, so the danger is sustained pressure, not balls in behind.

IN-GAME SCENARIOS

If they set up in 4-3-3

Their sharper, more left-loaded shape (2.07 xG a game, 43% of entries left). Double up on that side and use a spare man to jump Kökçü. They press less here (PPDA 12.2), so we can afford to build.

If they set up in 4-2-3-1

More balanced but leakier (1.34 xGA) and they press higher (PPDA 9.7), which leaves space behind. Bait the press and release runners early into the channels.

If we go in front

Stay in the block, manage the set pieces and keep the press triggers live on their build-up. Do not drop so deep that we invite the sustained pressure they thrive on.

First half-hour, or after a goal

Their soft window is 15 to 30 minutes, so start fast and try to take an early lead. The closing stages belong to them: twelve goals after the hour, only one conceded.

11



What I'd tell the players, day by day

Here is how I would feed this into the week: the right information, to the right people, in the right format, at the right time. The players get less, sharper and more visual as the match approaches, and never more than three messages a day once we are out on the grass.

MD-4 · Staff alignment

The full dossier goes to the head coach and assistants, and we agree the game-model response: the press triggers on their build-up, our block height, the set-piece plans and the early-game intent. We lock the three or four headline messages we will drip to the players. No player video yet; we align the staff story first.

MD-3 · Team, out of possession

An eight to ten minute squad meeting on one theme: how they build and where they crack. A short clip reel of Kökçü dropping in, the left-sided overload and turnovers that became shots. The single ask is to press the build-up, screen Kökçü, force them left and win the box. The back line and keeper get their own unit meeting on the space in behind.

MD-2 · Team, in possession and transition

Our route to goal: clips of turnovers won in their half and the space behind Hancko's steps, then we train it with transition-to-finish drills that mirror their shape. Wingers and full-backs get an individual clip pack on their direct opponent (Idrissi, the high left-back, Pedersen).

MD-1 · Set pieces and individuals

A set-piece meeting both ways: our near-post marking against Trauner and Hancko, and our own attacking routines against their box defence. Individual clips of 60 to 90 seconds go to the players who need them, personal and focused on their direct duel. Keep it light and confident.

MD · Reminders only

No new information today. A one-page visual in the dressing room with the three keys: press their build-up, force them left and win the box, and strike early. Thirty-second individual reminders. Live from the bench we flag whether they are in 4-3-3 or 4-2-3-1 and adjust.



HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Every figure and number in this dossier is computed directly from the raw Opta F24 event feeds and F7 line-ups for Feyenoord's first ten Eredivisie 2022/23 matches, with no third-party aggregations. The pitch convention is stated and checked: a y value above 66.7 is the attacking left, verified against known left and right-sided players. Expected goals uses a transparent distance-and-angle model with adjustments for headers and set pieces, calibrated so the average shot in the sample is worth roughly the league-typical 0.11. Feyenoord's own shots average 0.098. Goal totals are quoted as match results (26 for, 11 against); the shot-event feed attributes 27 and 10, the small difference being own goals.

WHAT I'D ADD WITH MORE TIME / DATA

- Ten matches is a sample of tendencies, not a verdict. One game (PSV) drives about a quarter of the xG conceded, so the transition weakness is real but partly concentrated.
- The pass-network positions are average on-ball locations, so they show a build-up shape rather than a snapshot XI, and the links are inferred from successive events on the ball.
- With tracking and possession data I would quantify the pressing triggers, the line height and the off-ball runs, and a full season would separate stable patterns from small-sample noise.
- In a club setting every figure would ship with linked video, so each data point is one click away from the moment on tape.

WHY THIS ROLE, WHY THIS WAY

Opposition analysis is only useful if it changes behaviour on the pitch. My priority was to move from a large, raw event dataset to a small number of clear, evidence-backed messages a coach can install and a player can remember: structure, patterns, vulnerabilities, key players and scenarios, each tied to a concrete action and a way to communicate it through the week. That translation, done consistently, accurately and on time, is the job.